LOGS · PROOF · 1/10

Screenshots freeze a moment. Logs remember everything.

The difference between 'it looked broken' and 'here is the exact request that broke'.

10 slides · swipe

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What a screenshot actually contains.

One pixel grid. One instant. Zero timing. Zero sequence. Zero 'what happened two requests ago'. A screenshot is a symptom photographed, not a cause observed.

A screenshot is a symptom.
A log is the mechanism.

What 30 seconds of logs tell you.

01 The first error — before the user's 'it broke'

02 The timestamp delta between trigger and failure

03 The exact request payload that tripped it

04 What the system tried, what it retried, what it gave up

05 Whether anyone else's request failed the same way

Reconstruct the story, don't photograph the scene.

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Debug from the log, not the UI.

01 Reproduce — same user, same input



02 Locate the first error line, not the last



03 Trace one request end-to-end across services



04 Only then open the screen — to confirm the fix

The screen is where you verify, not where you discover.

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The log shape I actually look for.

```
$ tail -f app.log | grep 500

09:14:02 POST /orders 500 — payload invalid

09:14:02 retry 1/3 — same error

09:14:07 alert fired — 3 users affected
```

Timestamp, request, verdict — in one glance.

Logs are evidence. Forged or real.

LYING LOGS

Log theater

info spam
no request ID
no correlation

HONEST LOGS

Evidence-grade

request IDs
structured fields
first error captured

Unstructured noise is not observability.

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The logging audit every team should run.

01 Can you replay one failing request from the logs?

02 Is the FIRST error logged, or only the final crash?

03 Are IDs propagated across service boundaries?

04 Would a screenshot still be 'necessary'?

If screenshots are still required, your logging is decorative.

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What good logging buys.

Postmortems in hours instead of weeks. Blame-free reviews because the timeline is undeniable. A team that debugs forward instead of haunting screens.

Timeline first.
Opinion second.

The logging law.

If your dashboard can't be replayed from logs at 3 a.m., it isn't visibility — it's decoration.

Observability is the ability to say 'I was there'.

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LOGS · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next postmortem.

When the next failure hits, skip the camera. Open the tail. The truth was there the whole time, between the first error and the alert.

Save for later review

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